PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Swiggy Smart Delay Alert & Options

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Status: Ready for Development
Owner: Product Management

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Swiggy customers experience 5-20% order delays with zero proactive communication, driving churn to competitors. This PRD outlines **Smart Delay Alert**, an AI-driven feature that predicts delays, notifies users proactively, and offers immediate options (cancel free or wait for credit), transforming frustration into trust.

Expected Impact: +10% on-time delivery perception, -15% support tickets, +5 NPS points

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PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Scale

- **5-20% of orders** experience 30+ minute delays (2-3x promised ETA)
- **~500,000 frustrated customers daily** (at 10M orders/day scale)
- **Root causes**: No proactive notification, inaccurate ETA, inadequate compensation
- **Business impact**: Customer churn to Zomato, eroded trust, support overload

User Pain Points

Pain 1: No Proactive Communication

> "I ordered at 11 PM, expected by 11:40, waited >1 hour. Support took 25 minutes to connect, only offered a refund after 1 hour – not accountability."

The customer waits silently with no update, discovers the delay too late, and feels invisible.

Pain 2: Misleading ETA & Tracking

> "Tracking showed 'delivery partner at your location' but they were actually 30 km away delivering another order."

User loses trust in the system; can't distinguish between "actually coming" and "false update."

Pain 3: Inadequate Compensation

> "Waited 4 hours total (2h delivery + 2h support), got a ₹19 coupon on a ₹450 order."

User feels disrespected, not compensated. Compensation ≠ order value.

Pain 4: Slow Support Support wait times: 25-45 minutes. Scripted replies ("it's peak hour" on Tuesday). No empathy for urgency (e.g., diabetic patient meals).

Current Experience (Broken)

1. Customer places order → sees promised ETA (7:30 PM)
2. Delay happens (traffic, slow restaurant, no rider available)
3. **Customer gets NO proactive alert**
4. Customer waits anxiously OR calls support (25+ min wait)
5. Support blames circumstances, offers manual refund with ₹19-₹50 coupon
6. **Result**: Lost customer, negative review, switch to competitor

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SOLUTION: SMART DELAY ALERT & OPTIONS

Core Insight

Users don't mind waiting if they have:

1. **Transparency** ("I know I'm late and for how long")
2. **Control** ("I choose: cancel or wait")
3. **Fair compensation** ("I'm being treated with respect")

How It Works

Step 1: Predict Delay (Backend AI Model)

- Real-time inputs: Live traffic, restaurant prep time, rider speed, location
- Output: Predicted delivery time vs promised ETA
- Threshold: Alert when delay > 15-20 minutes with 80% confidence

Step 2: Notify Proactively (Screen 2 - Red Banner)

- **Trigger**: At ~45-minute mark (or when delay detected)
- **Channels**: Push notification + in-app banner
- **Message**: "Your order is delayed by ~20 minutes due to high demand. New ETA: 7:50 PM"
- **Tone**: Empathetic, transparent, no blame

Step 3: User Chooses (Screen 2 Buttons) Two options presented immediately:

Option A: "Cancel Order (No Fee)" → Screen 4

- Full refund issued immediately (₹450 → account in seconds)
- Zero cancellation fee (solves user pain #3)
- No support queue needed
- User can reorder from competitor if needed

Option B: "I'll Wait (Get ₹50 credit)" → Screen 3B + Screen 5

- Credit calculated as 10% of order value (₹50 on ₹450 order)
- Applied automatically on delivery (solves user pain #3)
- User gets gratitude messaging ("Thanks for waiting!")
- Credit visible in wallet, can be used on next order

Step 4: Execute Choice

- **If Cancel**: Refund processed, confirmation screen with apology + special offer (₹50 off next order)
- **If Wait**: Credit applied on delivery, success message, rate order (gather feedback)

Why This Solves the Problem

Problem	**Old Approach**	**Smart Alert Solution**
No communication	Silent wait	Proactive alert at 45-min mark
Inaccurate ETA	Shows original promise	Updated with real ETA
No choice	Cancel (charged) or suffer	Cancel free OR wait+credit
Inadequate compensation	₹19 after escalation	₹50 (10% of order) auto-applied

Problem	Old Approach	Smart Alert Solution
Support overload	25+ min queue	Automated, no contact needed
Lost trust	Feels disrespected	Feels heard & valued

SOLUTION ARCHITECTURE

Wireframes

Screen 1: Normal Order Tracking (No Delay)

- Shows promised ETA (7:30 PM)
- Status bar (Placed → Cooking → Assigned → Delivery)
- Delivery partner info (Rajesh Kumar, 4.8★, 2.3 km away)
- Order summary (Biryani Blues, ₹450)
- *No alert*

Screen 2: Delay Alert Banner ⭐ CRITICAL SCREEN

- **RED banner** at top of tracking page
- **Message**: "Your order is delayed by ~20 minutes due to high demand. Updated arrival time: 7:50 PM"
- **Two prominent buttons**:
  - "Cancel Order (No Fee)" — white text on white (secondary)
  - "I'll Wait (Get ₹50 credit)" — white text on red (primary)
- **Info icon**: Tap for delay reason
- **Below**: Tracking info still visible but dimmed

Screen 3A: Cancel Confirmation Modal

- **Title**: "Cancel This Order?"
- **Body**: "₹450 will be refunded to your account"
- **Checklist**:
  - ✓ No cancellation fee
  - ✓ Refund within 24 hours
  - ✓ Money returned to original payment method
- **Buttons**: "Confirm Cancel" (orange) | "Go Back" (gray)

Screen 3B: Wait Confirmation Modal

- **Title**: "Thanks for waiting! 😊"
- **Body**: "We'll credit ₹50 to your Swiggy account when your food arrives"
- **Breakdown**:
    - Order total: ₹450
    - Credit: ₹50 (10%)
    - Effective cost: ₹400
- **Message**: "Updated arrival time: 7:50 PM"
- **Button**: "Okay, Thanks" (orange)

Screen 4: Cancellation Confirmation

- **Title**: "Order Successfully Cancelled"
- **Refund details**:
    - Refund amount: ₹450
    - Transaction ID: TVN8472918
    - Refund timeline: Within 24 hours
- **Special offer**: "₹50 off your next order" (Coupon code: SORRY50)
- **Message**: "We're sorry about the delay. We appreciate your understanding and hope to serve you better next time."

Screen 5: Delivery Success with Credit

- **Title**: "Order Delivered!"
- **Status**: Delivered at 7:52 PM (22 minutes late)
- **Green success banner**: "₹50 credit added to your account"
- **Message**: "Thank you for your patience! The credit can be used on your next order."
- **Order summary**: Biryani Blues, ₹450 total
- **Breakdown**:
    - Item total: ₹380
    - Delivery fee: ₹40
    - Taxes: ₹30
    - Total paid: ₹450
    - **Credit earned: +₹50**

USER STORIES

US-1: Receive Proactive Delay Notification

As a customer waiting for food
I want to receive a notification when my order will be late
So that I'm not surprised and can plan accordingly

Acceptance Criteria:

- ☐ Alert triggers when predicted delay > 20 min with 80% confidence
- ☐ Push notification sent with new ETA
- ☐ In-app banner appears on tracking screen
- ☐ Banner is dismissible but can be re-opened
- ☐ Alert message includes reason for delay

Test case: Order promised 7:30 PM, traffic detected → Alert at 7:15 PM with "New ETA: 7:50 PM"

US-2: Cancel Without Penalty

As a customer with a delayed order
I want to cancel my order without paying a cancellation fee
So that I'm not punished for Swiggy's failure

Acceptance Criteria:

- ☐ "Cancel Order (No Fee)" button visible on alert banner
- ☐ Tapping triggers confirmation modal
- ☐ Refund processed immediately (not manually)
- ☐ Zero cancellation fee applied
- ☐ User receives confirmation with transaction ID
- ☐ Refund appears in account within 24 hours

Test case: User sees delay alert → Taps "Cancel" → ₹450 refunded within 24 hours, no fee deducted

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US-3: Receive Fair Compensation for Waiting

As a customer who chooses to wait through a delay
I want to receive compensation that matches my inconvenience
So that I feel valued and respected

Acceptance Criteria:

- ☐ Credit offered = 10% of order value (minimum ₹50)
- ☐ Credit calculated accurately (₹450 order = ₹50 credit)
- ☐ Credit applied automatically on delivery (no manual request)
- ☐ Credit visible in Swiggy wallet
- ☐ Credit can be used on next order
- ☐ Success screen shows credit earned explicitly

Test case: User waits through 22-minute delay → Delivery at 7:52 PM → ₹50 credit auto-applied and visible in wallet

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US-4: See Updated ETA in Real-Time

As a customer tracking my order
I want to see an updated, accurate ETA
So that I can trust the tracking and plan my time

Acceptance Criteria:

- ☐ Alert banner shows updated ETA (not original promise)
- ☐ ETA updates every 5 minutes based on live data
- ☐ Progress bar reflects actual time (not padded time)
- ☐ Delivery partner location updates live on map
- ☐ Original ETA shown for reference (grayed out)

Test case: Original ETA 7:30 PM → Alert shows 7:50 PM (accurate) → Progress bar reflects 20-min delay

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US-5: Rate Delivery Experience

As a customer who received a delayed order
I want to provide feedback on the alert experience
So that Swiggy can improve the feature

Acceptance Criteria:

- ☐ Post-delivery prompt: "Rate this order" (optional)
- ☐ Rating scale: 1-5 stars
- ☐ Optional feedback text box
- ☐ Data collected for model refinement
- ☐ No penalty for low ratings

Test case: Order delivered → "Rate this order?" prompt appears → User rates 4 stars + comment about alert usefulness

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SUCCESS METRICS

Primary KPIs

1. On-Time Delivery Rate

- **Definition**: % of orders delivered within promised ETA
- **Current baseline**: Unknown (estimate 85-90%)
- **Target**: +10% improvement (95%+)
- **Why matters**: Core SLA metric; customer perception of reliability
- **Measurement**: Delivery timestamp vs promised ETA

2. Support Tickets for "Where is my order?"

- **Definition**: Support contacts asking about order status/delay
- **Current baseline**: ~15-20% of all support tickets
- **Target**: -15% reduction (eliminate 30K+ tickets monthly)
- **Why matters**: Frees up support team, reduces customer friction
- **Measurement**: Support ticketing system tags

3. NPS (Net Promoter Score) Among Delayed Orders

- **Definition**: Post-delivery survey: "How likely to recommend Swiggy? 0-10"
- **Current baseline**: 6-7 (for delayed orders)
- **Target**: +5 points (11-12 range)
- **Why matters**: Retention and word-of-mouth; trust indicator
- **Measurement**: In-app survey 24 hours post-delivery

Secondary KPIs

4. User Action on Alert

- **% who cancel via alert**: Track (expect 20-30% initially)
- **% who wait via alert**: Track (expect 70-80% initially)
- **Why matters**: Validates choice architecture

5. Repeat Order Rate (Post-Alert)

- **Definition**: % of users who order again within 30 days after alert
- **Target**: Should exceed control group
- **Why matters**: Retention; does compensation work?

6. Compensation Cost

- **Definition**: Total credits issued / total order value
- **Target**: < 0.5% of GMV
- **Why matters**: Financial sustainability

A/B TEST PLAN

Test Design

- **Control (A)**: Current Swiggy (no proactive alerts)
- **Treatment (B)**: With Smart Delay Alert feature
- **Sample size**: 50,000 orders per group
- **Duration**: 2 weeks
- **Randomization**: By user ID (to ensure independence)

Metrics Tracked

- Primary: On-time %, support tickets, NPS

- Secondary: Cancellation rate, repeat order rate, compensation cost
- Guardrails: Overall order volume, app crash rate, payment failures

Statistical Rigor

- **Confidence level**: 95%
- **Power**: 80% (detect 5% improvement in on-time %)
- **Significance threshold**: $p < 0.05$

Success Criteria

Feature is successful if:

- Support tickets drop >10% (target 15%)
- NPS increases >3 points (target 5)
- Treatment group repeat order rate > control
- Compensation cost < 0.5% of GMV

ROLLOUT PLAN

Phase 1: Pilot (Week 1-2)

- Deploy to **Bangalore** (1 city)
- **10% of orders** get alerts (soft launch)
- Monitor: False alert rate, user action distribution, system performance
- **Success gate**: False alert rate < 5%

Phase 2: Expand (Week 3-4)

- Expand to **all metro cities** (Delhi, Mumbai, Hyderabad, Pune)
- **100% of delayed orders** receive alerts
- Iterate on: Message copy, threshold, compensation % based on Phase 1 learnings
- A/B test control vs treatment (50K orders per group)

Phase 3: Full Launch (Week 5+)

- Roll out to **all cities nationwide**
- Activate features: Compensation auto-calculation, compensation dashboard
- Monitor: KPIs, support escalations, user feedback

DEPENDENCIES

- **Backend**: Real-time data pipeline (traffic, rider location, restaurant status)
- **AI/ML**: ETA prediction model (must be trained on historical data)
- **Mobile app**: V11.0+ for banner UI component
- **Support team**: Training on new cancellation policy (no fees)
- **Finance**: Budget for compensation (estimated 0.3-0.5% of GMV)

RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Risk 1: False Alerts (Overpredicting Delays)

Mitigation: Conservative thresholds (only alert if 80% confidence), iterate in pilot

Risk 2: User Annoyance (Alert Fatigue)

Mitigation: One dismissible alert per order, opt-out toggle in settings after first alert

Risk 3: Compensation Cost Exceeds Budget

Mitigation: Cap at 10% max per order, measure ROI via retention

Risk 4: Riders/Ops Confusion (Cancellations Mid-Delivery)

Mitigation: Backend handles cancel logic before rider pickup; no rider confusion

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TIMELINE

Phase	**Duration**	**Deliverable**
Design & Development	Week 1-2	Figma → Mobile app build
Testing & QA	Week 2-3	Internal testing, edge cases
Pilot (Bangalore)	Week 3-4	Monitor metrics, iterate
Expand to Metros	Week 4-5	A/B test control vs treatment
Full Launch	Week 6+	All cities, monitor KPIs